

Curriculum Map

A stakeholder view of the current curriculum planning wall: legal skills, advocacy competencies, and substantive law areas organized for program alignment.

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Skill area Topic Sub-topic Branch

Legal Skills

Foundations 8 topics	Ethics 2 topics	Pre-Engagement Prep 2 topics	Legal Writing 7 topics
Case Lifecycle	MA Rules of Prof. Conduct	Referral & Intake	Legal Writing Basics
History of Legal Aid	— Competence / Diligence	Conflict Checks	— Audience
Trauma-Informed Practice	— Confidentiality & A-C Privilege		— Active vs Passive Voice
Cultural Humility	— Conflicts of Interest		— Tone
Structural Competence	— Scope of Rep & Client-Directed Decisions		— Point of View
Systems Thinking	— Candor to Tribunal		— Plain Language vs Legalese
Working with Interpreters & Translators	— Duties to Third Parties		— Concise Sentences
Working with Interdisciplinary Teams (ethics, strategy, etc.)	— Supervising Paralegals, Law Students, Non-Legal Staff		— Limit Nominalizations
	— Withdrawal & Termination of Rep		— Remove Unnecessary Words
	— LSC Restrictions		Types of Legal Writing
	AI & Legal Aid		— Emails & Texts
			— Demand Letters
			— Memos
			— Briefs & Motions
			— Contracts & Transactional Documents
			— Training & Know Your Rights Material
			— Client Communications
			Legal Writing Prep
			Organization & Structure
			Clusters
			The Existing Process
			Legal Writing + AI

Legal Research 10 topics	Pre-Trial / Advocacy Skills 7 topics	Trial Skills / Advocacy 14 topics	Post-Trial Skills 3 topics
Legal Research Planning	Initial Client Interviews UNIT INTRO	Litigation Planning	Verdicts
Primary & Secondary Sources	– Trauma-Informed Interviewing	Pleadings	Post-Trial Motions
Research Strategy	– Working with Translators & Interpreters	Discovery	Preserving Issues for Appeal
Legal Databases	– Prep for Initial Client Interview	Motions	
Public Records & Open-Source Docs	– Building Client Rapport	Pre-Trial Conference	
Identifying Claims	– Establishing A-C Relationship	Jury Selection	
Identifying Defenses	– Eliciting Client Narrative	Exhibits	
Identifying Damages	– Open vs Closed Questions	Opening Statements	
Mapping Evidence & Elements	– Identifying Key Facts	Direct Exams	
Procedure & Logistics	– Issue Spotting	Cross Exams	
	– Threshold Legal Issues	Witnesses & Experts TENTATIVE	
	– Closing the Interview	Objections	
	– Documenting the Interview	Closing Statements	
	Informal Fact Investigation	Oral Argument / Best Practice TENTATIVE	
	– Planning for Informal Fact Investigation		
	– Record Releases		
	– Witness Interviews		
	– Physical Evidence		
	– Public Records & Open-Source Research		
	– Expert Consultation		
	Case Evaluation		
	Client Counseling		
	Case Strategy		
	Case Theory		
	Affirmative Litigation Planning		

Appellate Practice 6 topics Preserving Issues for Appeal Appellate Strategy Briefing TENTATIVE Oral Argument Rehearing / Rehearing en Banc Certiorari	ADR 3 topics Negotiation Arbitration Settlement	Legislative Advocacy 4 topics Preparing for Legislative Advocacy TENTATIVE Legislative & Budget Process TENTATIVE Administrative Advocacy TENTATIVE Lobbying Strategies TENTATIVE	Community / Movement Lawyering 4 topics Planning for Community / Movement Lawyering TENTATIVE Building Community Partnerships TENTATIVE Accountability & Ethics TENTATIVE Key Concepts TENTATIVE
Substantive Law			
Housing Law 0 topics Topics to be developed.	Family Law 0 topics Topics to be developed.	Immigration Law 0 topics Topics to be developed.	Education Law 0 topics Topics to be developed.
Employment Law 0 topics Topics to be developed.	Public Benefits Law 0 topics Topics to be developed.	Elder Law 0 topics Topics to be developed.	Health Law 0 topics Topics to be developed.
Consumer Protection Law 0 topics Topics to be developed.	Children's Law 0 topics Topics to be developed.		